

MAIN STREET TOOLBOX

Client Communication Kit for Service Businesses

Six proven scripts — estimate follow-ups, price increases, review requests, late payments, declined quotes and phone quotes. Copy, personalize, send.

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1. The estimate follow-up email

Send 2–3 days after delivering a quote. Most quotes die in silence, not rejection — one polite follow-up recovers a surprising share.

SUBJECT: YOUR QUOTE FROM {{BUSINESS NAME}}

Hi {{First Name}},

Quick follow-up on the {{job description}} quote I sent over on {{day}}. I still have {{week of}} open on my schedule if you'd like to lock it in.

Any questions I can answer — about the scope, the timing, or the price?

{{Your name}}

{{Business Name}} · {{phone}}

2. The price increase announcement

Send at least two weeks before the new prices take effect. Raise the underpriced services the most; keep the increase under ~10% a year for loyal regulars.

SUBJECT: {{BUSINESS NAME}} RATES — UPDATING {{MONTH}}

Hi {{First Name}},

Thank you for being a {{N}}-year customer — you're the reason this business exists.

A quick heads-up: starting {{effective date}}, my rates for {{service}} will move from {{old}} to {{new}}. Costs for {{fuel / supplies / insurance}} have climbed {{X}}% this year, and this adjustment keeps the service you're used to at the quality you expect.

Bookings made before {{effective date}} stay at the current rate — even for visits after it.

Thank you for your continued trust.

{{Your name}}

{{Business Name}} · {{phone}}

3. The review request (SMS)

Send within a few hours of the job, right after a compliment. Texting a link beats emailing — reviews happen on phones.

VARIANT A — RIGHT AFTER A COMPLIMENT:

"Thank you, {{First Name}} — glad the {{service}} worked out! If you have 30 seconds, a review helps my small business more than you know: {{review link}} Either way, see you next visit!"

VARIANT B — THE DAY AFTER:

"Hi {{First Name}}, {{Your name}} from {{Business Name}}. Hope the {{service}} is holding up well! If you were happy with it, a quick review would make my week: {{review link}} Thank you!"

NOTE: NEVER OFFER A DISCOUNT OR GIFT FOR REVIEWS — IT BREAKS MOST PLATFORMS' RULES AND IT SHOWS.

4. The late payment nudge (3-step sequence)

Automate the cadence; keep every step polite. Most late invoices are oversight, not refusal.

DAY 1 AFTER DUE DATE — FRIENDLY:

Subject: Invoice {{number}} — quick reminder

"Hi {{First Name}}, just a friendly nudge that invoice {{number}} ({{amount}}) came due {{due date}}. Likely slipped through — here's the link again: {{payment link}}. Thanks!"

DAY 14 — FIRMER:

Subject: Invoice {{number}} — still open

"Hi {{First Name}}, invoice {{number}} is now 14 days past due. Could you let me know when to expect payment? If something's wrong with the work or the invoice, I'd genuinely like to hear it — otherwise the link is here: {{payment link}}."

DAY 30 — FINAL NOTICE:

Subject: Invoice {{number}} — final notice

"Hi {{First Name}}, this is a final notice for invoice {{number}} ({{amount}}, 30 days past due). Per my terms, a {{late fee}} late charge applies after {{date}}. I value your business — please reach out if there's an issue we should talk about: {{phone}}."

(Keep late-fee terms on your written quotes so the final notice has teeth without surprise.)

5. The quote-declined reply

Send when a prospect goes with a cheaper bid. Grace costs nothing and wins the next job when the cheap bid goes wrong — and it often does.

SUBJECT: THANKS FOR THE OPPORTUNITY

Hi {{First Name}},

Thanks for considering {{Business Name}} — congrats on getting the {{job}} sorted.

If it's useful down the road: the {{specific element, e.g. warranty / prep work / insurance}} I included is the part cheap bids usually drop, so keep an eye on that spot.

If anything changes, my door's open. Have a great {{season}}!

{{Your name}}

6. The quick-job phone script

For the 'how much to just...' call. The phone quote is where margin dies — convert the call into a booked look-see instead.

CALLER: 'HOW MUCH TO {{JOB}}?'

You: 'That one's usually between {{low}} and {{high}} depending on {{the one variable}} — I can't tell which yours is without looking. I'm in {{area}} on {{day}}; want me to swing by? It's free, takes ten minutes, and you'll get a firm number on paper.'

Why it works: you gave a real range (so the call wasn't wasted), and the free look-see filters tire-kickers while doubling your close rate — written quotes convert several times better than numbers shouted over the phone.